REG-04 | Therapist only - all age groups

Expressing emotion and need

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Phrase a description, feeling, request or boundary the person can choose, and explore whom it is safe to tell and when. Practice communication without promising the other person's agreement.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Do not require approaching a harmful person, direct confrontation or private disclosure. Stating a boundary does not make a harmed person responsible for preventing harm. Practice only in the session or seek appropriate support.

Reusing existing material

SOC-01 already covers requests and boundaries; use existing wording if suitable. Here explore expressing the emotion and need identified in REG-02 and choosing an approach from REG-03, without preparing another full assertiveness sheet.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Maya wants visits arranged with her beforehand. She practices briefly describing the difficulty and asking for advance notice, then chooses whom to tell and when.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

About what issue would I like to express a need or boundary?

2 | Question for discussion

What is the factual description, and what feeling would I like to share?

3 | Question for discussion

What specific request or boundary will I choose to phrase?

4 | Question for discussion

What power differences and safety conditions need checking before contact?

5 | Question for discussion

How will I respond to refusal or not being heard without giving up my safety?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If finding perfect wording becomes a demand, return to one clear message. If a harmful response is feared, explore support rather than practicing confrontation.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Practice a short sentence in a fictional conversation with a safe adult. A child is not responsible for persuading an adult to protect them; direct contact with someone who caused harm is not required.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Respect the chosen communication channel and privacy. Check risks of online sharing or reactions in the setting before communicating a request or boundary.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Consider power differences and financial or professional dependence. Good wording does not guarantee a respectful response; suitable mediation may be needed.

OA | Older adults

Explore preferences for conversation, writing or chosen mediation. Do not let a companion speak for the person without consent.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Choose a safe, suitable opportunity with the person, or use only a fictional conversation in the session. Do not provoke anger or create conflict to complete the sheet. Skipping, stopping and seeking help are options. Harm and threats need an appropriate response before communication practice.

At the next session

Assess clarity, choice and boundaries, not only the other person's agreement. After rehearsal, the person may choose not to deliver the message if conditions are unsuitable.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.nhs.uk/mental-health/feelings-symptoms-behaviours/feelings-and-symptoms/anger/

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